

Australia Daily Brief

Tuesday, October 6, 2026

1,771 words · 7 min read

RE: Coalition unveils biggest migration cut in Australian history · Hundreds protest AUKUS-linked Land Forces expo in Perth · Albanese warns Pacific leaders of hellish Australian summer at Pre-COP31 · Tuvalu adviser says Canberra overstepped · NZ National support weakest since 2020

ASX 200

8,736

+0.30%

AUD/USD

0.6973

-0.23%

NZX 50

13,700

+0.12%

NZD/USD

0.5608

-0.59%

IN THIS ISSUE [Top Stories](#) · [Overnight](#) · [Stat](#) · [Pacific](#) · [New Zealand](#) · [Canberra](#) · [Markets](#) · [Upcoming](#) · [The Wire](#)

• TODAY AT A GLANCE

- 1 Angus Taylor unveiled a Coalition plan to cut net overseas migration to 100,000 for two years, slashing the temporary visa intake by roughly 650,000 over four years without releasing economic modelling.
- 2 Pacific leaders gathered in Fiji and Tuvalu for Pre-COP31 heard Anthony Albanese warn of a fire, cyclone and extreme heat summer ahead, while a Tuvalu government adviser accused Canberra of overstepping during the visit.
- 3 New Zealand's National party recorded its weakest poll support since 2020 five weeks before the November 7 election, as a former Army soldier convicted of attempted espionage lost his bid to keep his identity secret.

• TOP STORIES

AU-DEFENSE

Hundreds protest against Australia's largest defence expo in Perth

About four hundred protesters gathered in Perth against the Land Forces expo, Australia's largest land defence event, held October 6 to 8 at the Perth Convention and Exhibition Centre with industry representatives from sixty countries and almost one thousand exhibiting organisations. Western Australia police received ten days of temporary special powers and *\$11.5 million* for policing, including the ability to ban excluded persons from the security zone. Placards opposed the AUKUS submarine deal, two years after clashes at the expo's Melbourne edition.

per ABC News: "Hundreds protest against Australia's largest defence expo in Perth" · also ABC News: "WA has high hopes for Land Forces as anti-war activists prepare to protest"

AU-POLITICS

Coalition unveils 100,000 migration cap in sweeping overhaul

Angus Taylor unveiled a Coalition plan to cut net overseas migration to 100,000 for two years, then 130,000 and 160,000 in years three and four, slashing the temporary intake by about 650,000 over four years through changes to graduate, humanitarian and bridging visas. Net overseas migration fell to 292,100 in the year to March; Labor is targeting 245,000 this financial year and 225,000 the next. Taylor offered no modelling of the economic impact, promising costings closer to the 2028 election.

per ABC Politics: "Graduate visas face the axe in Coalition migration overhaul" · also SMH Federal Politics: "Taylor enters three-way migration battle with 100,000 target as Labor and One Nation fire back"

PACIFIC-DIPLOMACY

Albanese warns Pacific leaders of a hellish Australian summer

Anthony Albanese told Pacific leaders gathered in Fiji for Pre-COP31 that climate change combined with a monster El Nino would hit Australia hard with fire, cyclones and extreme heat. The four-day meeting, co-hosted by Fiji and Tuvalu, sets the agenda ahead of November's COP31 in Türkiye. Papua New Guinea Prime Minister **James Marape**, the first leader to arrive, pledged financial help for Tuvalu's land reclamation project and attacked countries that keep emitting without addressing Pacific damage.

per SMH: "Fire, cyclones, extreme heat: Albanese's hellish summer forecast" · also ABC Pacific: "PNG PM pledges financial help to Tuvalu to combat rising seas at Pre-COP"

AU-FOREIGN-POLICY

Greens under fire over opposition to Ukraine military aid

Ukraine's top representative in Australia urged the Greens to reconsider their opposition to providing military aid against Russia's invasion, as Labor and the Coalition accused the party of a naive stance that would hand **Vladimir Putin** a gift. The Ukrainian diaspora joined both major parties in the criticism. The row follows the Greens setting defence red lines opposing arms for Ukraine and seeking to curtail the US alliance, carried in this brief on October 3.

per SMH Federal Politics (Matthew Knott): "Shameful, repugnant": Greens under fire over opposition to Ukraine military aid"

• OVERNIGHT

PACIFIC-DIPLOMACY [Tuvalu government adviser says Australia overstepped in Pre-COP visit](#) · AFP

A Tuvalu government adviser said Australia overstepped during the Pre-COP leaders' visit to the atoll nation, AFP reported. Tuvalu used the two-day visit by leaders attending Fiji's Pre-COP to display its climate vulnerabilities, with the President of Mauritius and the President of Timor-Leste the only non-Pacific heads of state to attend.

NZ-FOREIGN-POLICY [Flydubai co-pilot trained partly in New Zealand, police say](#) · Reuters

Police confirmed the flydubai co-pilot at the centre of an attempted-attack investigation completed part of his flight training in New Zealand. The Financial Times carried the same finding. The

Australian reported Israel is demanding an urgent Australian terror inquiry, and the Washington Post said Australia has launched its own probe into the co-pilot's past.

US-AUSTRALIA

[Analysts warn US allies' bases risk becoming targets](#) · ABC News

Analysts say the alleged plot near Britain's RAF Fairford, a base used by US bombers, shows American allies risk becoming targets in their own right. Six men were arrested and released on bail. **Donald Trump** said "we actually know the people who made the threat" after ordering the US bomber fleet out of the United Kingdom; Iranian Foreign Minister **Abbas Araghchi** denied involvement.

AU-DEFENSE

[Defence names Corporal Brendan Hannam as soldier killed in NT rollover](#) · The Australian

The Australian Defence Force identified 28-year-old Corporal Brendan Hannam as the soldier killed in a vehicle rollover at the Mount Bunday Training Area, about 100 kilometres south-east of Darwin, on Monday afternoon. Five other soldiers were flown to Royal Darwin Hospital. Chief of Army Lieutenant General **Susan Coyle** and Minister for Defence Personnel **Matt Keogh** were among those responding.

PACIFIC-DIPLOMACY

[UN warns intense heat puts Pacific births in jeopardy](#) · AFP

The UN told the Pre-COP talks in Fiji that intense heat is putting pregnancies and births in jeopardy, adding a public health dimension to the Pacific's push for stronger commitments before COP31 in Türkiye next month.

TRADE-ECONOMY

[Consumer confidence plunges to 30-year low after RBA rate rise](#) · AFR

Australian consumer confidence fell to a 30-year low following the Reserve Bank's rate rise, the AFR reported, saying the figures signal mounting voter unease with the Albanese government's economic management after a torrid week for federal Labor.

• STAT OF THE DAY

650,000

temporary visas cut under Coalition migration plan

Angus Taylor would reduce Australia's temporary migration intake by about 650,000 over four years, with no modelling released on the economic impact.

ABC Politics

• PACIFIC WIRE

COOK ISLANDS · RNZ PACIFIC

[Cook Islands authority says seabed exploration runs to 2032](#)

The Cook Islands Seabed Minerals Authority said exploration will continue until 2032 and that no commercial minerals harvesting has been approved under current licences. Three exploration licences, held by Moana Minerals Limited, Cook Islands Cobalt Limited and American Ocean Minerals Corporation, come up for renewal in 2027. Lowy Institute researchers concluded in late August that commercial mining in pro-mining Pacific states could begin as early as 2027, driven by US-China competition over critical minerals.

SOLOMON ISLANDS · ISLANDS BUSINESS

Wale urges Pacific shift in climate spending

Solomon Islands Prime Minister **Matthew Wale** called for greater investment in reefs, mangroves and other natural coastal defences rather than hard infrastructure such as seawalls, as regional leaders met for Pre-COP31 in Fiji.

VANUATU · ABC PACIFIC

Vanuatu shipowners call for a national ship repair slipway

The Vanuatu Shipowners Association is pressing the government for a national slipway and more investment in the Vanuatu Maritime College, almost a month after the MV Matui sank between Santo and Ambae with more than thirty lives lost. Chairman **Andrew Bohn** said the country "prioritised service over safety for the past many years, probably decades".

SAMOA · ISLANDS BUSINESS

Samoa journalists demand answers over deleted photos

Samoa journalists want answers after security personnel reportedly removed a camera and deleted photographs taken by a newspaper reporter, raising fresh press freedom questions.

PAPUA NEW GUINEA · ABC PACIFIC

El Nino forces East New Britain to shut schools for months

Authorities in Papua New Guinea's East New Britain province will close schools for the next four to six months and have halted village markets over health and safety concerns. Provincial Administrator **Levi Mano** said the measures were intended to protect schoolchildren and the public and to stretch scarce water and other resources.

PALAU · PACIFIC ISLAND TIMES

Palau's balancing act amid a growing regional leadership role

Pacific Island Times examines Palau's widening regional role, arguing that maps understate a sovereign nation defined by culture, traditional values and strong relationships. Palau takes the Pacific Islands Forum chair from Solomon Islands at the Koror leaders meeting.

FIJI · ISLANDS BUSINESS

Fiji opens COP31 stakeholder forum with call for Pacific voices to lead

Fiji's Minister for Environment and Climate Change **Lynda Tabuya** told a COP31 stakeholder forum that climate decisions must be shaped by Pacific communities before negotiating positions are set.

REGIONAL · ISLANDS BUSINESS

American Samoa governor opposes commercial deep-sea mining lease

American Samoa Governor **Pulaali'i Nikolao Pula** filed formal comments with the US Bureau of Ocean Energy Management opposing commercial extraction under a proposed deep-sea mining lease covering more than 31 million acres, saying initial activity should be limited to scientific research and environmental studies.

FIJI · ABC PACIFIC

Fiji kava prices more than double in a single year

Fiji's kava industry is under strain as domestic and export prices surge, driven by bad weather and the world fuel crisis. Exporter **Krish Prasad** said he has considered closing his export company: "In Fiji, I would definitely make more doing that."

● NEW ZEALAND

NZ-POLITICS · REUTERS

National support at weakest level since 2020, poll finds

Support for **Christopher Luxon's** National party has fallen to its weakest level since 2020, Reuters reported, five weeks before the November 7 general election. Advance voting opens October 26.

NZ-DEFENSE · RNZ

Former soldier named in New Zealand's first attempted espionage case

Jack Alexander Captein, dismissed from service and sentenced to two years in military detention in August last year after trying to defect and passing restricted material to someone he believed was a foreign agent, lost his bid for name suppression. Justice **Christine French** said it was "not seriously arguable" that open justice was outweighed. Captein had links to two right-wing groups.

NZ-POLITICS · BLOOMBERG

New Zealand firms upbeat on the economy despite soft demand

New Zealand businesses report improving confidence in the economic outlook even as demand stays soft, Bloomberg reported, a split signal five weeks out from the general election.

• CANBERRA POLITICS

AU-POLITICS · SMH FEDERAL POLITICS

Hanson-Young breaks silence on Greens leadership showdown

South Australian senator **Sarah Hanson-Young** said she would not "be salty" about the Greens leadership contest, arguing progressive forces must unite to stop **Pauline Hanson** and One Nation from "wrecking this nation".

AU-POLITICS · THE AUSTRALIAN

Lights go out at Pre-COP31 summit, leaving Steggall in the dark

Independent MP **Zali Steggall** was left in the dark when power failed at the Pre-COP31 venue, The Australian reported, as the government fields questions over the guest list for the Fiji meeting.

AU-POLITICS · ABC NEWS

OpenAI executive tells Sydney hearing he cannot explain Australian distrust of AI

OpenAI chief strategy officer **Jason Kwon** made his first public appearance in Sydney since the Medicare website breach, telling a parliamentary inquiry into artificial intelligence that he could not explain why Australians distrust AI. The company said additional monitoring is now in place.

• BUSINESS AND ECONOMY

TRADE-ECONOMY · BLOOMBERG

Chalmers says bond selloff will pressure the Australian budget

Treasurer **Jim Chalmers** said higher bond yields will put pressure on the Australian budget, speaking during his swing through Tokyo where he is pitching Australia as a safe haven for Japanese investment.

PACIFIC-DIPLOMACY · FBC NEWS

Fiji places critical infrastructure at the centre of the Vuvale Union

Protecting ports, airports, energy systems and telecommunications is being placed at the centre of the Fiji-Australia Vuvale Union and the Ocean of Peace Alliance. Permanent Secretary for Finance **Shiri Goundar** said economic security depends on keeping critical infrastructure running through natural disasters and external shocks.

• UPCOMING

OCT
8

Land Forces expo closes in Perth

Three days of defence industry deals and protest activity in Western Australia, the state the AUKUS submarine sustainment effort runs through.

OCT
26

Advance voting opens for the New Zealand general election

National's weakest polling since 2020 raises the chance of a changed coalition and a new foreign affairs portfolio holder.

OCT
2026

Pre-COP31 concludes in Fiji and Tuvalu

The four-day meeting sets the negotiating agenda Australia will preside over at COP31.

NOV
7

New Zealand general election

Determines whether the National, ACT and NZ First coalition continues and who holds foreign affairs and defence.

DEC
9

Fiji referendum on constitutional reforms

Prime Minister Sitiveni Rabuka has set aside the date for a vote on sweeping constitutional changes.

• THE WIRE

PACIFIC-POLITICS

DEVPOLICY BLOG

PNG's food tax cut delivered only eight toea in every kina to the poorest

World Bank research by **Chris Hoy** and **Kingtau Mambon** finds Papua New Guinea's food tax cut mostly benefited supermarkets and richer households, with the poorest receiving just *eight toea per kina* spent.

AU-DEFENSE

ASPI STRATEGIST

The Army's emerging littoral force needs a northern logistics system

The Strategist argues the government must build an integrated northern logistics system from military and civilian capabilities if the Army's littoral force, set out in the Australian Army Contribution to the National Defence Strategy 2026, is to work.

PACIFIC-DIPLOMACY

ISLANDS BUSINESS

COP31 must deliver for the Pacific, not just raise ambition, Bowen says

Climate Change and Energy Minister **Chris Bowen** said the COP31 process would put Pacific priorities at the centre of the climate negotiations Australia will preside over.

ISLANDS BUSINESS

Rabuka calls the Pacific climate crisis a warning to the world

Fiji Prime Minister **Sitiveni Rabuka** told the Pre-COP gathering that the climate crisis facing Pacific island communities is a warning for the rest of the world.

US-AUSTRALIA

USSC

USSC report argues Australia needs AI agency after the data breach

The United States Studies Centre released a report arguing Australia needs greater agency over artificial intelligence, published as OpenAI executives faced a parliamentary inquiry over a breach involving a Medicare website.

NZ-POLITICS

RNZ

New Zealand cocaine consumption near seven kilograms a week

Police wastewater testing put New Zealand cocaine use at close to seven kilograms a week in the second quarter of 2026, down from a record 9.4 kilograms in late 2025. The New Zealand Drug Trends Survey, led by Massey University professor **Chris Wilkins**, found 31 percent of respondents reported cocaine use, against 11 percent in 2017/2018.

CSIS Australia Chair

AUSTRALIA DAILY BRIEF

Washington, D.C.

[Read online](#)

[Past issues](#)

You are receiving the Australia Daily Brief as a member of the CSIS Australia Chair distribution list.

This newsletter is automatically generated, so it may contain errors. Please check all information and sources before citing. To report errors or other issues, please contact Andy Lim at alim@csis.org.

generated 6:11 AM ET

[↑ BACK TO TOP](#)